

What Happens to Your Body When You Drink Coffee Every Day

By [Lauren Panoff, MPH, RD](#) | Published on December 02, 2025

✓ Medically reviewed by [Maggie Moon, MS, RD](#)



[Make Healthier Coffee](#)

Key Takeaways

Moderate coffee consumption (up to 400 milligrams of caffeine for healthy adults, or about 3 to 4 cups daily) may benefit brain, heart, and metabolic health.

difference in how healthful it is.

Drinking coffee every day can enhance your focus and reduce the risk of chronic diseases, but it may also cause sleep disruptions and digestive issues. Understanding these benefits and risks helps you make informed decisions about your coffee habits.

Ways Coffee May Be Good for Your Health

1. Your Focus, Energy, and Alertness Improve

Caffeine is a stimulant that blocks adenosine , a brain chemical that regulates sleep.^[1] Drinking coffee can make you feel more alert and mentally sharp. Some studies also suggest that coffee may enhance brain performance and mood.^[2]



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2. Your Risk for Chronic Disease Decreases

Research has suggested that regular coffee drinkers may have a reduced risk of developing certain conditions, such as type 2 diabetes, Parkinson's

people new to caffeine and exercise. In other words, coffee might temporarily help you burn more calories and body fat, especially if you consume it before you exercise.^{[9][10]}

5. You May Live Longer

necessarily related to caffeine.^[13]

Drawbacks of Regular Coffee Drinking

1. You May Experience Anxiety or Jitters

Drinking coffee can make symptoms like nervousness and restlessness worse—especially for people who are prone to anxiety. Caffeine is also known to cause jitters.^[14]

2. You Might Feel Some Digestive Effects

For some people, drinking coffee can irritate the lining of the stomach and cause acid reflux or heartburn, especially if drunk on an empty stomach.^[15] Caffeine also acts as a mild laxative, which may or may not be a desired effect.^[16]

3. Your Sleep May Be Disrupted

Caffeine has a half-life (the concentration of a substance to decrease by half) of around five hours, which means it can remain in your system for 10 hours after drinking it.^[17] If you drink coffee in the afternoon, you may find it difficult to fall asleep at bedtime, especially if you're not a regular caffeine drinker.

Inadequate or disrupted sleep can lead to other issues, like low energy, mood changes, trouble concentrating, and an impaired immune system.^[18]

4. You May Get Withdrawal Symptoms

Over time, your body can develop a tolerance to coffee, meaning that you

What Is a Safe Amount of Coffee to Drink?

Most healthy adults can safely consume up to 400 milligrams (mg) of caffeine (3–4 cups) daily.^{[14][21]}

someone who has a lower caffeine tolerance, even that 400 mg mark might be too much for you, triggering jitters, anxiety, or making it harder to fall asleep.

Healthcare providers may instruct some people to reduce their caffeine intake. For instance, pregnant people should keep their consumption to 200 mg per day or less.^[23]

Remember, coffee isn't the only source of caffeine. Certain teas, energy drinks, chocolate, and soda can also contain caffeine. So, if you notice health effects associated with caffeine intake, consider all the possible sources in your diet.

Ways to Make Coffee Healthier

When researchers study the [health effects of coffee](#), they typically study its most basic form: black coffee. However, black coffee can be bitter, and not everyone cares for the flavor. Many add cream and sugar to make coffee more palatable. However, this can provide excess sugar and calories.

Keep the following tips in mind for healthier coffee:

Keep it simple: Reduce or cut out added sweeteners, flavoring agents, and whipped cream in specialty coffee drinks.

Opt for plant-based milk: Whole milk is high in saturated fat, which is not good for heart health.^[24] Instead, try soy, oat, or almond milk in your coffee or latte.

Choose decaf: If you're a caffeine-sensitive person, decaf coffee may serve you better. It still provides the experience you enjoy, while reducing the risk of unwanted side effects.

— [National Cancer Institute](#)